There can't be grey areas on facts, though there can be differing interpretations of what they mean.

The Mehta–Singh Social Index and Why Scholars Got the BJP's Caste Matrix Wrong: BJP No More an Upper Caste-Dominated Party

To uncover the facts, critically reassess the emerging picture and get to the root of this issue, I decided to take a fresh look at the caste backgrounds of political leaders in UP cutting across four parties—BJP, SP, BSP and Congress—as they evolved over time. Working closely with the journalist Sanjeev Singh, I investigated the caste backgrounds of UP politicians across five domains to create what we called the Mehta–Singh Social Index for this book. Our findings show how empirically wrong the caste researchers at Ashoka University were. We then pursued this enquiry beyond just MPs and MLAs elected by political parties. Legislators do form a critical group, but to get a fuller picture, the Mehta–Singh Social Index also looked at the changing caste patterns of BJP state-level officer-bearers, district-level presidents and ministers stretching across the BJP and its rival governments in UP. Overall, we studied the castes of:

- 2,560 Lok Sabha candidates fielded by the BJP, SP, Congress and BSP in each of UP's 80 Lok Sabha constituencies and in every single national election over three decades (1991–2019);
- 1,612 Vidhan Sabha candidates fielded by the four parties in 403 assembly constituencies in the 2017 state election;
- 42 state-level BJP office-bearers in UP in 2020;
- 101 government ministers in UP, stretching across BJP chief minister Yogi Adityanath's council of ministers (54) in 2020 and SP chief minister Akhilesh Yadav's council of ministers (47) in 2012.
- 98 district-level BJP presidents in UP in 2020.

All of these political structures needed re-examining because looking at one piece of the caste puzzle is not enough and can sometimes be misleading. The point of creating the Mehta–Singh